



2025 Annual Report

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Indigenous People Alliance Ghana (IPA-GH)

Quince street, Adenta - Accra
P.O.Box AF 73

Business Registration No.: CG081931124 | Founded (officially): 2024 | Registered Office: Accra

Board of Directors

Dr Vincent Von Vordzogbe, Chair
Nana Atta Fianko II, Vice Chair

Executive Lead: Lord Offei-Darko

Annual Council Meeting: Ordinary
Annual Council Meeting 16 June 2025

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Founders Message

As we reflect on the 2025 calendar year, it is clear that this period marked a defining moment for the Indigenous Peoples Alliance Ghana (IPA-GH). We set out not only to implement projects, but to contribute meaningfully to reshaping climate justice discourse and practice in Ghana. Through the disciplined execution of our strategic pillars, IPA-GH transitioned from an emerging idea into a structured, data-driven movement engaging policymakers, academic institutions, and international development partners.

The year was characterized by a deliberate shift from localized advocacy to growing national relevance. With a total expenditure of USD 28,520, IPA-GH demonstrated strong fiscal discipline and an ability to deliver high-impact results with limited resources. Operating at the intersection of environmental governance and social equity, we implemented two flagship initiatives: the **Marginalized Groups Empowerment for Climate Justice (MGE CJ)** project, supported by the Youth Climate Justice Fund, and the Safeguarding Livelihoods of Rural Communities from Climate-Induced Disasters (SAFE) project, funded by the Mastercard Foundation through the Bridge in Agriculture Programme. Together, these interventions advanced our core mission of ensuring that rural women, youth, and indigenous farmers are not only protected from climate risks but are also active contributors to locally grounded solutions.

As we look ahead to 2026 and the implementation of our “**Scaling for Equity**” strategic plan, we do so with a tested and credible foundation. Our approaches have been piloted, our assumptions validated, and trusted partnerships built—from rural communities such as Sankpala to national-level institutions in Accra. IPA-GH is increasingly positioned as a platform for community-driven, systems-oriented change. We invite you to engage with this report, which documents not only measurable results but also the lived experiences of resilience and leadership that continue to shape our work.

Thank you for your partnership and belief in our mission.



Lord Offei-Darko
Founder and CEO



David Djangmah Tawiah
Co-Founder, Operations

Executive Summary

The 2025 Annual Report provides a comprehensive evaluation of the Indigenous People Alliance Ghana's operational and project milestones. This year, IPA-GH successfully executed a dual-track project focused on Policy Advocacy and Economic Resilience, expending a total of USD 28,520.00 to achieve high-value outcomes for marginalized communities across Ghana.

The organization's flagship initiative, the Marginalized Groups Empowerment for Climate Justice (MGE CJ) project, was pivotal in contributing to the "Equity Gap" in Ghana's environmental governance. Through a series of targeted workshops in Southern and Northern Ghana, the project convened 72 participants, achieving a 90% engagement rate among marginalized women, youth, and indigenous farmers. The project's intellectual centrepiece, a National Research Study, mobilized over 300 youth data contributors, culminating in a landmark publication titled "Assessing the Ghana National Youth Policy and its Impact on Youth Climate Justice". This study serves as a critical tool for lobbying the National Climate Change Policy review process. Furthermore, the project's storytelling component produced two full-length documentaries capturing the lived realities of two indigenous communities, validating traditional resilience strategies for a global audience.

Simultaneously, IPA-GH launched the Safeguarding Livelihoods of Rural Communities from Climate-Induced Disasters (SAFE) project, funded by the Mastercard Foundation Bridge in Agriculture (BIA) Programme. This initiative addressed the economic vulnerability of rural households by introducing sustainable apiculture (beekeeping) as a climate-resilient livelihood. Key deliverables included the procurement and installation of 10 modern beehives, specialised community training for 20 youth and women, and the initiation of research into the "Gendered Impacts of Beekeeping Adoption on Household Income".

Despite challenges related to logistical reach in dispersed rural settlements and the inherent difficulties of language barriers in multi-ethnic regions, IPA-GH successfully mitigated these risks through the employment of local interpreters and strategic community partnerships. The year concluded with the organization firmly positioned to transition into its 2026–2028 strategic phase, having demonstrated a capability to scale impact from a seed funding base of \$600 to over \$28,000 in annual revenue.

Jacqueline Okine,
Lead, Knowledge and Impact



Overview & Strategy

Mission

IPA-GH's mission is to support indigenous peoples, rural youth, and marginalized communities in Ghana to overcome systemic inequalities by enhancing their capacity for rights-based advocacy, inclusive policy engagement, and sustainable livelihood development. Through community-driven approaches, IPA-GH contributes to equitable governance, climate resilience, and sustainable development outcomes.

Strategic Outcomes

Increased Social Equity

People affected by global issues such as climate change impacts must be able to seek safety and claim their basic rights.

IPA-GH's Goal:

By 2028, IPA-GH will have supported (directly or indirectly) 500 indigenous people affected by climate change impacts to be able to advocate and lobby for their rights.

Enhanced Economic Resilience

Indigenous people affected by climate change impacts must be able to pursue self-reliance economically.

IPA-GH's Goal:

By 2028, IPA-GH will have piloted (directly or indirectly) the api-resilience fund to train and support at least 20 indigenous people affected by climate change impacts to adopt beekeeping.

The realization of these breakthroughs is supported by a set of strategic components that shape IPA-GH's overall direction and approach. These components are articulated as Strategic Program Initiatives that directly support local implementation, Strategic Priorities that advance IPA-GH's core objectives of protection and inclusion, and Organizational Principles that guide institutional practice and partnerships.

Strategic Components

Capacity Building

We empower marginalized groups to lobby and advocate. We don't just speak for them; we train them to speak for themselves in policy forums and approach policymakers effectively.

Sustainable Livelihoods

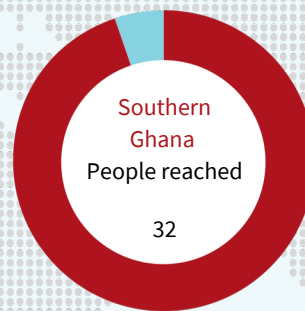
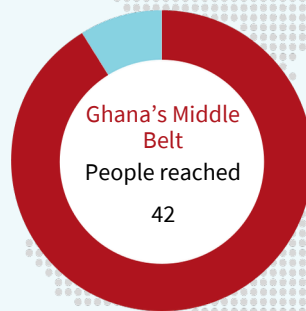
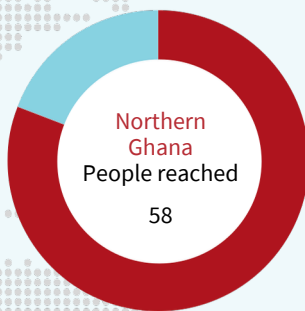
We support indigenous social enterprises, specifically Beekeeping & Honey Production, to provide climate-resilient income. Better value for money and more sustainable financing.

Organizational principles

Accountability | Inclusion | Community-Led | Sustainability

Local Results

Indigeneous People Reached



0.00038% indigenous people reached



Breakthrough 1

IPA-GH supported rural people affected by climate change to be able to lobby and advocate for their rights to secure livelihoods, food and water security, and a clean and sustainable environment.



Breakthrough 2

IPA-GH supported smallholder farmers affected by climate change in indigenous communities with beekeeping as an alternate livelihood choices.

Project Performance I



The Marginalized Groups Empowerment for Climate Justice (MGE CJ) project was conceived to critically examine the disparate impact of Ghana's climate change strategies on vulnerable populations. The overarching goal was to foster inclusivity in climate justice dialogues and strengthen the network of institutions advocating for change. The project addressed a fundamental "Equity Gap"—the historical exclusion of rural and indigenous voices from national policy discussions, which has resulted in interventions that often fail to address the specific realities of those bearing the brunt of the climate crisis.

Key Activities and Implementation Strategies

The Southern Ghana Workshop served as the foundational effort to disrupt the status quo of exclusion. We meticulously selected 32 participants from various regions in southern Ghana, prioritizing those historically marginalized by systemic inequalities. The cohort comprised 16 youth representatives, identified as the future custodians of climate action, and 16 individuals from indigenous communities, including persons with disabilities, rural farmers, and the elderly. This deliberate mix ensured that the dialogue was not theoretical but grounded in the lived experiences of those most affected. The workshop successfully established a nascent network of advocates equipped to challenge exclusion in their local districts.

The "National Research Study" was the intellectual core of the MGE CJ project, designed to transition advocacy from anecdote to evidence. We initiated a massive data collection drive, engaging over 300 data contributors from across the nation. To ensure intergenerational equity, 75% of these contributors were youth, with a mandated 15% representation from rural and indigenous communities. The resulting publication, "Assessing the Ghana National Youth Policy and its Impact on Youth Climate Justice in Ghana," provides actionable, data-driven recommendations. It serves as an undeniable mandate for the National Climate Change Policy review board, ensuring that the next iteration of national strategy cannot ignore the specific vulnerabilities and solutions proposed by the next generation.

Recognizing the acute vulnerability of the Northern sector to climate-induced desertification and drought, we executed a strategic intervention in this region. This workshop was designed to address the gendered dimensions of climate justice. We convened 42 participants, comprising a decisive majority of 27 women alongside 13 male farmers. This gender composition was intentional, aiming to overturn traditional norms that often silence women in public forums. By positioning women, who are the primary managers of household food security and water resources, as the central knowledge bearers, we achieved a fundamental shift in local power dynamics. These women provided detailed, expert knowledge on drought-resistant crops and water management, validating their role as indispensable architects of climate resilience.

To complement our quantitative data, the "Documenting Everyday Realities" activity utilized the power of visual narrative to humanize complex policy issues. We deployed media teams to three distinct indigenous communities across the Eastern, Bono East, and Northern regions. Through extensive interviews with over 15 individuals, including policymakers, chiefs, and climate-affected farmers, we produced two full-length video documentaries. These assets successfully validated indigenous resilience strategies, packaging them into compelling narratives that resonate with stakeholders who might otherwise remain unmoved by statistical reports alone.

Project Performance II

While the MGEJ project focused on policy and rights, the SAFE project was designed to address the immediate economic precarity of our target communities. In climate hotspots like the middle belt of Ghana, up to 70% of households rely on unstable rain-fed subsistence farming. The SAFE project aims to introduce beekeeping and honey production as an alternative, climate-resilient income source. Beekeeping requires minimal land, provides income during dry seasons when crops fail, and boosts local biodiversity through pollination service.



Key Activities and Implementation Strategies

The first phase of the SAFE project focused on technical skills transfer. We successfully identified training venues and mobilized community participants, targeting a cohort of 20 individuals, specifically prioritizing youth and women. The curriculum covered sustainable colony management, harvesting techniques, and safety protocols. By equipping participants with these skills, we are ensuring that the apiaries are managed professionally, maximizing honey yields and ensuring the longevity of the enterprise.

Aligning with our "Knowledge Diplomacy" pillar, the SAFE project includes a research component titled "Gendered Impacts of Beekeeping Adoption on Household Income in Climate Vulnerable Communities". Data collection for this study is on track. This research aims to quantify exactly how alternative livelihood interventions impact the financial autonomy of rural women, providing the necessary data to justify scaling this model to other districts.

To translate training into economic value, IPA-GH facilitated the physical establishment of the pilot apiary. This involved the procurement and installation of 10 beehives, 10 hive stands, 8 roofing sheets, and essential protective gear including 2 bee suits, 2 smokers, and 3 pairs of gloves. The logistical execution included site clearing, transportation of equipment to remote rural locations, and the engagement of local labourers to assist in the setup. This activity successfully moved the project from concept to physical reality, providing the community with a tangible asset base.

The procurement and farm installation phases have been completed successfully ("On track"). The training modules have been deployed to the target demographic. We are currently monitoring the colonization rates of the hives. A potential delay has been identified regarding the publication of the peer-reviewed journal article associated with the research component. Mitigation strategies, including additional academic support for the research team, are being implemented to ensure this deliverable is met in the subsequent reporting cycle.

STORIES FROM THE FIELD

In the community of Sankpala, identified as a high-climate hotspot in the Northern Region, the prevailing story on the ground is one of resilience stifled by systemic exclusion. The central challenge faced by residents, particularly the female farmers who secure the community's food supply, is the struggle to manage intensifying resource scarcity while battling traditional gender norms that limit their public voice. Although these women hold critical, centuries-old indigenous knowledge regarding drought-resistant crops and water management strategies, they have historically been culturally conditioned to remain silent during community decision-making processes.

Achieving intermediate or durable solutions remains a challenge in the contexts we operate in. However, IPA-GH remains committed to prioritizing this ambition going forward.

Over the next three years, IPA-GH aims to transition from pilot interventions to systemic change by executing a massive expansion of its advocacy and economic programs. The organization projects growing its internal capacity to 14 full-time co-creators, enabling the training of over 500 marginalized groups in policy advocacy so they can directly lobby for inclusive governance. Simultaneously, the alliance plans to deploy the Ghana Api-Resilience Fund (GARF) to launch 25 community-owned beekeeping enterprises, establishing a robust economic foundation that provides climate-resilient incomes for indigenous farmers.

To ensure these initiatives outlast the grant cycle, IPA-GH is implementing a long-term sustainability model designed to operate beyond donor dependency. The projection relies on a circular financial ecosystem where profits from the social enterprises are reinvested into the organization, supplemented by revenue from technical consulting services and indigenous cultural events. This approach guarantees that the organization can continue to fund its operations and expand its impact indefinitely, securing a lasting legacy of self-sufficiency for the communities it serves.

Strategic Foresight

STORIES FROM THE FIELD

In Northern Ghana, traditional gender norms and cultural expectations frequently restrict women's participation in public forums, often causing them to remain silent during broader community gatherings and policy discussions. Although these women, particularly farmers, possess vital indigenous knowledge regarding food security and climate adaptation, this systemic exclusion historically marginalizes their voices, leaving their expertise underrepresented in national environmental policy-making.



Photo: Omar Tardig



Safeguarding & Code of Conduct

At Indigenous Peoples Alliance Ghana (IPA-GH), safeguarding is a core institutional commitment and an integral part of how we deliver our mission. Beyond compliance with donor and regulatory requirements, safeguarding reflects our responsibility to protect the rights, dignity, and well-being of the communities we serve. Given our direct engagement with marginalized groups including rural women, youth, persons with disabilities, and indigenous farmers, we uphold a strict zero-tolerance policy toward all forms of harassment, exploitation, abuse, or neglect.

IPA-GH's Code of Conduct applies to all Board members, staff, volunteers, and partners and sets clear expectations for ethical behaviour, professional integrity, and accountability. It mandates that all interactions prioritise physical safety, emotional well-being, respect, and informed participation. Safeguarding principles are embedded across our programs, ensuring that community members can engage freely and confidently, without fear of discrimination, retaliation, or harm. We believe that sustainable climate justice and inclusive development are only possible within safe, respectful, and empowering environments.

Operational Safeguarding in Community Outreach

Our outreach strategy is designed with built-in protective measures to mitigate risks associated with power imbalances. During our regional workshops, such as the Southern and Northern Ghana sessions, we implemented strict protocols to ensure safe participation. This included funding travel to remove economic barriers and selecting venues that were accessible to persons with disabilities and the elderly. Furthermore, recognizing the cultural hierarchies that often silence women in public forums, we engineered our sessions to disrupt these dynamics safely. In the Northern Ghana Workshop, we successfully created a protected space where 27 female farmers could lead discussions on climate adaptation, shifting local power dynamics while ensuring their cultural safety.

Ethical Research and Data Integrity

In executing our National Research Study and Storytelling projects, safeguarding the intellectual and personal data of our contributors was paramount. With over 300 data contributors involved, we adhered to strict ethical standards regarding informed consent and representation. Our "Documenting Everyday Realities" initiative required staff to undergo training in culturally sensitive communication to ensure that the stories of indigenous resilience were captured accurately and respectfully, without exploitation. We ensured that the 300+ youth and indigenous contributors were not merely subjects of study but active partners whose knowledge was validated and protected for national policy influence.

Risk Management and Inclusivity

To enforce this conduct, IPA-GH utilized a dynamic risk register to identify and mitigate potential safeguarding issues, such as language barriers that could lead to exclusion or misinterpretation. We proactively engaged local interpreters and produced workshop learning materials in local languages, ensuring that no participant was left vulnerable due to a lack of understanding. This level of care allowed us to bridge the gap between marginalised rural communities and national policymakers, transforming a baseline of zero engagement into a robust and safe network for advocacy.

Financial Management Review

Revenue and Funding Landscape in the reported fiscal period:

IPA-GH's total revenue reached GHS 356,500.00 (USD 28,520.00), derived entirely from project-specific grant funding. Unlike larger organizations with diversified income streams, IPA-GH currently operates on a 100% restricted funding model, where every cedi is tied to specific deliverables within the "Marginalized Groups Empowerment for Climate Justice" project. While this grant funding provided the essential capital to launch core activities, the organization acknowledges the risks of donor dependency. Consequently, the strategic outlook for the 2026–2028 period focuses heavily on diversification, aiming to generate unrestricted income through the "Ghana Api-Resilience Fund" social enterprise model to sustain future operations.

Largest Operational Impacts on Finance Strategic Capacity Building

To ensure rigorous execution and robust monitoring, IPA-GH allocated the largest portion of its financial resources, 50.5% (GHS 180,000.00), to Personnel salaries and wages. This strategic decision to invest in human capital (co-creators) was critical for managing the logistical complexity of coordinating 300+ research contributors and executing workshops across dispersed regions. Operational Overhead – Administrative and overhead costs accounted for 23.4% (GHS 83,405.97) of the total expenditure. This allocation covered essential office rent, utilities, and annual audits, ensuring that the organization maintained a compliant and professional headquarters to support its field teams and satisfy standard NGO requirement.

Balanced Budgeting

The organisation practised a zero-based budgeting approach for this grant period, ensuring that the total expenditure of GHS 356,500.00 exactly matched the grant funding received, leaving a balance of zero. This reflects high efficiency in fund utilisation but highlights the need for the upcoming "Scaling for Equity" phase to build financial reserves for long-term sustainability.

Program Spending & Project Inputs and Direct Implementation:

Despite inflationary pressures on goods and services, IPA-GH successfully directed significant funds into direct program costs. 10.8% (GHS 38,625.00) of the budget was utilized for "Workshop & Training" expenses, covering accommodation, venue rentals, and feeding for the Southern and Northern Ghana workshops that convened 72 participants. Livelihood Investments – A further 7.9% (GHS 28,100.00) was invested directly into "Project Inputs" for the Beekeeping implementation. This capital expenditure procured tangible assets for community resilience, including hives, protective gear (suits, gloves, smokers), and consumables, directly supporting the establishment of climate-resilient incomes for beneficiaries.

Logistics and Visibility

To bridge the gap between rural communities and national policy, 5.4% (GHS 19,369.03) was spent on logistics, specifically vehicle rentals and fuel, enabling the team to reach remote areas like Sankpala. Additionally, 2% (GHS 7,000.00) was allocated to "Visibility," funding the production of high-quality photo and video documentaries to capture indigenous realities.

Financial Items and Economic Environment Currency Volatility Management

Operating in a fluctuating economic environment, IPA-GH adopted a prudent approach to forex management. The budget was calculated at a fixed exchange rate of 12.5 GHS/USD, with a specific line item for "Bank Charges" and "Forex losses" totaling GHS 5,405.97. This buffer allowed the organization to absorb transfer fees and minor exchange rate dips without compromising projects delivery.

Risk Management



IPA-GH operates in geographically dispersed and culturally complex environments to fulfill its vision of empowering marginalized communities for climate justice. These contexts require IPA-GH to manage a variety of systemic and logistical risks effectively to ensure that the voices of the most vulnerable are not only heard but acted upon.

Operational and Access Risks

IPA-GH operated in complex and hard-to-reach contexts, particularly within geographically dispersed communities in the Northern sector. While distance and infrastructure limitations required careful logistical planning, these conditions were proactively addressed through flexible field coordination, phased community engagement, and collaboration with local actors. These approaches enabled IPA-GH to maintain broad and meaningful representation across target communities.

Language diversity was also a key consideration in ensuring inclusive participation and data quality. IPA-GH mitigated this risk by working with community facilitators and local interpreters, ensuring that engagement processes were culturally appropriate and accessible. As a result, participation remained inclusive, and data collection reflected authentic community perspectives, reinforcing the integrity and effectiveness of the project.

Financial and Funding Risks

Ensuring genuine and equitable participation required targeted financial investments, particularly in supporting the travel and participation of marginalized rural farmers in regional workshops. While these costs increased budgetary pressure, they reflected IPA-GH's intentional commitment to inclusivity and access. The organization actively managed this risk through prudent budget controls, cost-efficiency measures, and strategic prioritization of essential activities. This approach enabled IPA-GH to uphold its inclusion standards while maintaining overall financial discipline and project delivery.

Project and Inclusion Risks

IPA-GH proactively addressed inclusion risks related to gender norms by adopting inclusive facilitation approaches that enabled meaningful participation by women, particularly in Northern Ghana. This ensured that women's indigenous knowledge on food security and livelihoods was effectively integrated into project outcomes. Post-implementation learning also highlighted the value of earlier engagement with Metropolitan, Municipal, and District Assemblies (MMDAs) to accelerate policy uptake, informing a strengthened stakeholder engagement approach for future programming.

Management Statement

The Board of Directors and Executive Management Team of Indigenous Peoples Alliance Ghana (IPA-GH) have reviewed and approved the Annual Report and Financial Statements for the reporting period ending 17 December 2025. This review was conducted to ensure accuracy, completeness, and consistency with the organization's strategic objectives and governance standards. The Board is satisfied that the report presents a credible and transparent account of IPA-GH's activities and performance during the period under review.

This Annual Report has been prepared in full compliance with IPA-GH's governing bylaws, the reporting requirements outlined in our grant agreements, and the applicable accounting and regulatory standards for Non-Governmental Organizations under Ghana's Companies Act, 2019 (Act 992). Due diligence was applied throughout the reporting process to ensure adherence to statutory and donor-specific obligations. This compliance underscores IPA-GH's commitment to sound governance and institutional integrity.

Throughout the reporting period, resource mobilization and grant management were conducted in accordance with ethical fundraising principles and the contractual obligations agreed with our partners. IPA-GH consistently upheld high standards of transparency, accountability, and stewardship in the management of donor funds. These practices strengthened partner confidence and ensured that resources were applied solely for their intended programmatic purposes.

In our opinion, the accompanying financial statements present a true and fair view of the organization's financial position as at December 2025. They accurately reflect the financial performance and cash flows associated with activities implemented under the Marginalized Groups Empowerment for Climate Justice (MGE CJ) project within the approved grant timeframe. The statements provide a reliable basis for assessing the organization's financial health and operational efficiency.

We further confirm that robust internal controls, financial management systems, and business procedures are in place to ensure that all transactions comply with approved budgets, legal requirements, and donor agreements. These controls support timely financial reporting, risk mitigation, and accountability across all project activities. Financial prudence and value for money were consistently applied, enabling the efficient and effective use of resources to maximize impact at the community level.

Finally, we believe that the Management Review provides a balanced and comprehensive account of IPA-GH's operational performance during the reporting period. It highlights the outcomes achieved across Southern and Northern Ghana, while transparently outlining the strategic risks identified and managed. On this basis, the Annual Report is hereby recommended to the Board for formal adoption.

